

Coordinating and Subordinating Conjunctions

Conjunctions are words that link other words, phrases, or clauses together. They play a crucial role in constructing coherent and meaningful sentences. Below is a comprehensive list of coordinating and subordinating conjunctions.

Coordinating Conjunctions

Coordinating conjunctions join words, phrases, or independent clauses of equal rank. The acronym **FANBOYS** helps remember the seven coordinating conjunctions:

1. **For** - indicates reason or purpose (e.g., She stayed home, for she was feeling ill.)
2. **And** - adds one thing to another (e.g., I like tea and coffee.)
3. **Nor** - presents an alternative negative idea to an already stated negative idea (e.g., He doesn't drink milk, nor does he eat cheese.)
4. **But** - shows contrast (e.g., I wanted to go out, but it started raining.)
5. **Or** - presents an alternative or choice (e.g., Would you like tea or coffee?)
6. **Yet** - introduces a contrasting idea that follows logically (e.g., It was late, yet he kept working.)
7. **So** - indicates consequence or result (e.g., She was tired, so she went to bed early.)

Subordinating Conjunctions

Subordinating conjunctions introduce dependent clauses and show the relationship between the dependent clause and the rest of the sentence. Below is an exhaustive list:

Cause or Reason

- Because
- Since
- As
- So that
- In order that
- For the reason that

Time

- After
- Before
- When
- While
- As
- Since

- Until
- As soon as
- As long as
- Once
- Whenever

Condition

- If
- Unless
- Provided that
- As long as
- In case
- Supposing
- Even if

Contrast or Concession

- Although
- Though
- Even though
- Whereas
- While
- Even if
- Despite the fact that

Purpose

- So that
- In order that
- That
- For the purpose of

Comparison

- Than
- As...as
- As if
- As though

Manner

- As
- The way

- In the way that

Result

- So that
- Such that
- That

Examples

1. She went to the market **because** she needed groceries.
2. I stayed home **although** the weather was nice.
3. **If** it rains, we will cancel the picnic.

Relative Pronouns and Question Words

These words often act like subordinating conjunctions when they introduce dependent clauses. They are:

Relative Pronouns:

- Who
- Whom
- Whose
- Which
- That

Question Words:

- What
- When
- Where
- Why
- How
- Whoever
- Whomever
- Whatever
- Whenever
- Wherever
- However

Examples:

- I don't know **where** she went.

- She helped the student **who** was struggling.